

CONSUMER PRICE INDICES AND INFLATION RATES FOR APRIL, 2025

The annual consumer price inflation as measured by the Consumer Price Index (CPI) was 4.1 per cent in April 2025. This implies that the general price level in April 2025 was 4.1 per cent higher than it was in April 2024. The price increase was primarily driven by rise in price of items in the Divisions of Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages (7.1%); Transport (2.3%) and Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and other fuels (0.8%) over the one year period. These three divisions together account for over 57 per cent of the total weight across the 13 major expenditure categories.

The CPI measures the cost of purchasing a fixed basket of goods and services, comparing current prices to those of a base period (February 2019). The inflation rate is derived from data collected through a monthly survey of retail prices that targets a representative basket of household goods and services, with data gathered during the second and third weeks of the month from a statistically representative sample of outlets in urban areas across 50 data collection zones nationwide.

As presented in Table 1 and Table 2, the overall index increased from 143.69 in March 2025 to 144.09 in April 2025, resulting in a monthly inflation of 0.3 per cent.

Table 1: Overall CPI and Rates of Inflation

Index Reference Period Feb 2019 = 100		
Month	Overall CPI	Inflation Rate
April 2024	138.40	5.0
May 2024	139.64	5.0
June 2024	140.23	4.6
July 2024	139.94	4.3
August 2024	139.87	4.4
September 2024	140.13	3.6
October 2024	140.44	2.7
November 2024	140.81	2.8
December 2024	141.66	3.0
January 2025	142.68	3.3
February 2025	143.12	3.5
March 2025	143.69	3.6
April 2025	144.09	4.1

As shown in Table 2, the Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages Index increased by 0.4 per cent between March 2025 and April 2025. Notably, prices of potatoes (Irish), maize grain (loose) and fortified maize flour rose by 4.0, 2.9 and 2.6 per cent, respectively, between March 2025 and April 2025. During the same period, prices of kale- *Sukuma wiki* and cabbages dropped by 2.3 per cent and 4.0 per cent, respectively, as presented in Table 3, which provides national average prices of selected items.

The Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and Other Fuels' Index rose by 0.3 per cent between March 2025 and April 2025. The increase was mainly on account of rise in the prices of 50kWh electricity, 200 kWh electricity and gas/LPG by 3.8, 3.4 and 0.3 per cent between March 2025 and April 2025. Conversely, prices of kerosene dropped by 1.6 per cent over the same period.

As presented in Table 2, the Transport Index rose by 0.5 per cent between March 2025 and April 2025 mainly attributable to increase in prices of country bus fares during Easter Holidays. Prices of petrol and diesel declined by 1.1 per cent and 1.3 per cent in the review period, as presented in Table 3.

Table 2: One and Twelve-Month Percentage Changes in the Consumer Price Indices

	Weight %	% Change on last month (April 2025/ March 2025)	% Change on same month of the previous year (April 2025/ April 2024)
13 COICOP Divisions			
Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages	32.9094	0.4	7.1
Alcoholic Beverages, Tobacco and Narcotics	3.3289	0.2	6.0
Clothing and Footwear	2.9914	0.0	3.8
Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and Other Fuels	14.6124	0.3	0.8
Furnishings, Household Equipment and Routine Household Maintenance	3.7372	0.2	3.1
Health	2.9116	0.2	3.4
Transport	9.6468	0.5	2.3
Information and Communication	7.7840	0.0	1.0
Recreation, Sport and Culture	1.7219	0.3	3.3
Education Services	5.5620	0.0	2.7
Restaurants and Accommodation Services	8.0991	0.3	4.1
Insurance and Financial Services	2.2423	0.0	0.9
Personal Care, Social Protection and Miscellaneous Goods and Services	4.4532	0.2	3.5
Total	100.0000	0.3	4.1

Table 3: National Average Retail Prices of Selected Commodities

Commodity Name	Quantity	Unit of Measure	Average Price April 2024	Average Price March 2025	Average Price April 2025	% Change over last month April 2025/ March 2025	% Change over last year April 2025/ April 2024
Potatoes (Irish)	1	Kg	111.82	126.48	131.55	4.0	17.6
Maize Grain - Loose	1	Kg	62.98	64.72	66.60	2.9	5.8
Fortified Maize flour	2	Kg	159.01	165.05	169.41	2.6	6.5
Tomatoes	1	Kg	65.23	80.88	81.88	1.2	25.5
Sugar	1	Kg	173.70	166.08	167.25	0.7	-3.7
Beef - With Bones	1	Kg	625.84	672.52	674.80	0.3	7.8
Wheat Flour-White	2	Kg	186.03	167.39	165.96	-0.9	-10.8
Cooking Oil (Salad)	1	Litre	329.73	353.01	349.28	-1.1	5.9
Traditional Vegetables	1	Kg	90.39	108.95	106.60	-2.2	17.9
Kale-Sukuma Wiki	1	Kg	65.13	88.51	86.47	-2.3	32.8
Cabbages	1	Kg	63.29	77.90	74.75	-4.0	18.1
Electricity	50	kWh	1,311.50	1,268.08	1,315.81	3.8	0.3
Electricity	200	kWh	6,297.78	5,687.00	5,877.92	3.4	-6.7
Gas/LPG	13	Kg	3,242.11	3,146.03	3,156.19	0.3	-2.7
House rent - 2 bedroom	1	Per Month	18,140.20	18,307.60	18,312.77	0.0	1.0
Kerosene/Paraffin	1	Litre	171.18	152.18	149.78	-1.6	-12.5
Country Bus /Matatu Fare (Malindi to Nairobi)	1	Ticket	1,700.00	1,800.00	2,200.00	22.2	29.4
Petrol	1	Litre	194.46	177.25	175.30	-1.1	-9.9
Diesel	1	Litre	181.11	167.84	165.64	-1.3	-8.5

Core inflation is a measure of inflation that is compiled from products whose prices are non-volatile. The computation of core and non-core inflation follows the same procedure used in compilation of headline inflation. Core Index and Non-Core Index are computed first followed by core and non-inflation rates. The concept of core inflation is to remove most or all the products whose prices are volatile or transient from the overall index. By removing such products from the index, the remaining less volatile index, better demonstrates the fundamental changes in the rate of inflation.

As presented in Table 4, the rate of core inflation was 2.5 per cent in April 2025. The core index increased from 128.35 in March 2025 to 128.48 in April 2025. Non-core inflation was 8.4 per cent during the same period.

Table 4: Core and Non-Core Index and Inflation Rate, April 2025

Period	Core index	Core Inflation	Non-Core index	Non-Core Inflation
Apr-24	125.31	4.3	190.91	7.3
May-24	125.49	3.4	197.51	10.2
Jun-24	125.66	2.8	198.96	10.1
Jul-24	125.66	2.2	197.48	10.8
Aug-24	125.80	2.2	195.90	10.3
Sep-24	125.88	2.0	196.87	7.7
Oct-24	126.20	1.8	197.36	5.1
Nov-24	126.76	2.1	197.51	4.6
Dec-24	127.50	2.2	198.51	4.9
Jan-25	127.77	2.0	202.87	6.8
Feb-25	128.01	1.9	204.01	7.7
Mar-25	128.35	2.2	205.55	7.4
Apr-25	128.48	2.5	206.86	8.4

Contribution of core and non-core inflation to the overall inflation is presented in Table 5. Core inflation contributed 2.6 points while non-core contributed 1.5 points to the overall inflation in April 2025. Food and non-alcoholic beverages contributed 2.1 points to the overall inflation rate.

Table 5: Core and Non-Core Contributions in April 2025

Broad Categories	Core	Non-Core	Total
Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages	0.6	1.5	2.1
Alcoholic Beverages, Tobacco and Narcotics	0.2	0.0	0.2
Clothing and Footwear	0.2	0.0	0.2
Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and Other Fuels	0.2	0.0	0.2
Furnishings, Household Equipment and Routine Household	0.2	0.0	0.2
Health	0.1	0.0	0.1
Transport	0.2	0.0	0.2
Information and Communication	0.1	0.0	0.1
Recreation, Sport and Culture	0.1	0.0	0.1
Education Services	0.2	0.0	0.2
Restaurants and Accommodation Services	0.3	0.0	0.3
Insurance and Financial Services	0.0	0.0	0.0
Personal Care, Social Protection and Miscellaneous Goods	0.2	0.0	0.2
Total	2.6	1.5	4.1



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